

5.7 Architectural

Architectural shots are all about angles. The most boring kind of architectural photos are taken head on, and in close up. If the subject is in an urban area, go back a bit, walk around the building a few times, and look at options for getting into a building to get a shot. The colours are very important here, but they can be adjusted later on. Try to get an eccentric angle, if the subject is eccentric. Repeated patterns filling the frame can be impressive, but only if the angle looks aesthetic. Avoid monolithic shots of a single subject dominating a frame. Instead, get some of the background. Top down architectural photos are more interesting than bottom up architectural photos.

Approach the photo according to the subject. If the subject is a rustic rural building, capture an expanse of the rural landscape to go with it. If it is an impressive, but old building, focus on the features on the building itself, like the windows, statues or the roofs. If the building is a modern or industrial structure, include a chimney, cars or some people in the snapshot to bring out the industrial or urban look in the photo.

When it comes to architectural shots, you can go wild focussing on tiny details. Observation is the key here, look out for interesting oddities in the building to capture. This could range from a door frame, to a signboard or a light fixture.

Be careful while photographing heritage structures and religious monuments. Taking photos inside many religious structures is not allowed, and is insulting even if there is no sign that says so. By and large, heritage sites should not be a problem, but while capturing frescoes, be polite and turn off the flash in your camera. When possible, buy postcards, because you are not likely to get better photos anyway. Photographing in some public areas is also not allowed, for example railway stations. Though you might not encounter anyone who will stop you, it is not a good idea to take photos as it is illegal by law.

Architectural photos offer a lot of room for framing. This means that a building can be framed from the gate, or a fort framed from an entrance in the wall. Explore both symmetric and asymmetric compositions.